

Resources

Structured guides on how hiring actually works.

LinkedIn Networking — Strategy & Principles



How to Read a Job Description



How Hiring Works



Why Referrals Matter



How To Use LinkedIn Correctly



How To Prepare Before Applying



How to Interpret Rejection



How To Close Skill Gaps



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↗ Commenting beats posting at your follower count

For accounts under 1K followers, substantive comments on others' posts produce a reported ~55% lift in profile views when delivered 5–10x per day. Posting alone reaches no one when you have no audience yet. Build the audience by joining other people's conversations first.

The Comment Coach below is the highest-leverage AI tool in this app for getting noticed.

💬 What makes a comment count

- **15+ words minimum.** "Great post!" / "So true!" / "100%" add nothing — research-backed signal of low effort
- **Reference something specific** the original poster said (a phrase, a number, a claim)
- **Add your own concrete experience** — a real number, a real example, a real counterexample
- **Sweet spot: 50–150 words.** Over 200 words reads as hijacking the post for your own monologue

🕒 Reply window matters

When someone comments on your post, replying within **30 minutes** correlates with 64% more total comments and 2.3x more views. The first 60 minutes determine whether the post breaks out beyond your direct connections — under 500 impressions in hour 1 typically caps further reach.

👤 Connection request strategy

- **Weekly cap:** ~100 invites/week is the standard limit. Spread across 5–6 days; sending 100 in one morning gets flagged
- **Acceptance floor:** stay above 30% acceptance rate or LinkedIn restricts your account
- **With note vs without — contested:** personalized notes don't always lift acceptance rate, but they DO lift the post-acceptance reply rate (9.4% vs 5.4%). A short note referencing mutual context (alumni, course, shared event) is the safe default
- **Free LinkedIn track:** only 5 personalized note invites per month. Premium lifts this

👥 Cold outreach reply rates by recipient

- **HR / talent acquisition: ~12.1% reply rate** — the highest of any recipient type. For students, DMing recruiters is higher-yield than DMing hiring managers
- **First-degree connections: ~16.9% reply rate** — leverage existing network before going cold
- **LinkedIn DMs vs cold email: 10.3% vs 5.1%** — LinkedIn outperforms email for reaching new people

👁 Open To Work — toggle, not the green badge

- **The private "Open to Recruiters" toggle is uncontroversial** — only LinkedIn Recruiter customers see your status. Use it.
- **The public green #OpenToWork badge is contested.** 70% of recruiters in a LinkedIn poll view it positively, but reporting in Fortune (Sept 2024) and trade press argues it can read as desperate or trigger lowball offers in competitive markets
- **Trade-off, not a rule.** If you're applying broadly to many roles → the public badge surfaces you to more recruiters. If you're targeting a few specific competitive roles → consider the private toggle

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Cold outreach reply rates by recipient

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